Quarter End Operational Response

3:30-5:00 PM | Three concurrent incidents | Decision and communication plan

> **Command decision.** I would open one incident bridge, name a lead for each workstream, and keep a timestamped decision log. The first command is to stop further payment corruption. The 3PL and contract teams work at the same time; a priority rank determines escalation attention, not when the other teams may start.

Triage and resource allocation

Rank / clock	Immediate move	Owner and rationale
1 / now	Quarantine the affected payment run and disable the corrupt script; preserve records.	**Finance + IT.** Ongoing cash leakage and supplier interruption can compound with every run.
2 / parallel	Open the 3PL bridge; obtain outage scope, restoration ETA, and the list of 1,200+ exposed orders.	**Logistics + Customer Success.** Broad customer impact and breached SLAs require immediate containment and honest updates.
3 / parallel	Diagnose provisioning and check the approved recovery path and audit status.	**IT + Sales Ops + Compliance.** A 5:00 PM deadline and 15% target exposure warrant a dedicated team, with no control bypass.

The next 90 minutes

Time	Decision and evidence required
3:30-3:40	Assign leads and open the bridge. Finance/IT confirm the script and affected payment batches are stopped. Logistics requests the 3PL ETA. IT identifies the provisioning failure. Send the executive update below.
3:40-4:15	Reconcile payment and bank records; contact critical unpaid suppliers. Segment orders by promised date and feasible alternate capacity. Test an approved provisioning repair or rollback; confirm compliance readiness.
4:15-4:40	Verify results, not status labels: bank/payment reconciliation, actual fulfillment release evidence, and customer access plus audit approval if provisioning succeeds. Update impacted stakeholders with confirmed facts.
4:40-5:00	Give CEO/CFO a decision checkpoint: verified recovery, residual exposure, owners, and next ETA. Controller determines any Q3 recognition. Record unresolved items and maintain controls into the next shift.

Executive update to CEO and CFO | send at 3:40 PM

> **Subject: Quarter-end operations incident - three active risks**
>
> We have three concurrent incidents. **Vendor payments:** a script caused duplicate and missed payments; Finance and IT are stopping the affected flow and reconciling bank and AP records, with confirmation due by 3:45. **Fulfillment:** the 3PL outage has exposed 1,200+ orders to SLA breaches; Logistics is pursuing a restoration ETA and feasible alternate capacity, while Customer Success prepares targeted updates. **Enterprise contract:** provisioning failed on a deal equal to 15% of the quarterly target; IT is testing an approved recovery path with Compliance engaged. The Controller will determine Q3 revenue treatment from the contract and performance evidence; billing or a changed system status alone will not establish recognition.
>
> I am coordinating the bridge. Workstream leads are Finance/IT, Logistics/Customer Success, and IT/Sales Ops/Compliance. I will send verified exposure, recovery status, and any approval requests at 4:15 PM.

Recovery, communications and control decision

Payment record corruption | immediate containment

Step	Action and release criterion
1. Stop	Finance/IT disable the automation and quarantine only the affected payment batches and vendor-record changes. Preserve the script version, logs, payment files, approvals, and timestamps.
2. Bound	Finance compares AP obligations, the vendor master, ERP ledger, payment files, and bank settlement status. Produce one list of duplicates, missed payments, amounts, and critical suppliers; distinguish sent from merely queued.
3. Recover	Treasury contacts the bank immediately for traces and possible recalls of duplicate payments. Track each outcome; do not assume a sent payment can be reversed. Correct accounting records through approved entries.
4. Protect	For critical unpaid suppliers, verify banking details against an independent trusted source, then use an approved two-person payment path. The supplier owner communicates the confirmed status and next update.
5. Validate	A second Finance reviewer reconciles the corrected AP ledger to bank activity and underlying obligations. Keep the affected flow paused until exceptions are resolved and the reviewer signs off.
6. Restart	IT rolls back or fixes the script, tests duplicate and missing-payment cases, and obtains Finance approval before controlled restart. Monitor the next run and retain an audit trail.

Communication rules and accountability

Customers: Customer Success identifies the affected orders and sends a factual delay notice and next-update time; it gives a revised ship date only after Logistics confirms it. **Suppliers:** Finance and the supplier owner contact those at risk of service pause with a verified payment status. **Enterprise client:** Sales gives the actual onboarding status and a confirmed next update. Each workstream lead reports evidence and blockers on the incident bridge every 15 minutes; I maintain the log and escalate decisions to CEO/CFO.

Bonus decision note | VP Sales and Head of Compliance

> **Decision: Hold provisioning until the mandatory 24-hour compliance and privacy audit is complete.** I will not use the manual override because it deliberately bypasses a required control for this customer. Previous experience with this client tier does not establish clearance for this contract. IT will continue restoring the pipeline, and Compliance will run the audit without delay. Sales will give the client an accurate activation update. I will tell the CFO that the quarter-end target is at risk and ask the Controller to assess revenue recognition under company policy. We will not backdate activation, invoices, or accounting records. I will record the decision and report progress at 4:15 PM.

One SOP modification

Add a gated Compliance Ready milestone: when final contract terms and required customer data are available, Sales Ops starts the 24-hour audit at least one day before planned activation. Provisioning cannot begin until Compliance marks the audit complete; a material change reopens the review. This moves the control earlier without weakening it.

Why this sequence

I prioritize active cash loss, broad customer impact, and the fixed contract deadline. Dedicated parallel owners prevent a queue. I require verified outcomes before declaring recovery or giving a revised ETA.

Accounting reference: IFRS Foundation, IFRS 15, revenue recognition when a performance obligation is satisfied by transferring the promised good or service: ifrs.org/issued-standards/list-of-standards/ifrs-15-revenue-from-contracts-with-customers. Apply the company's governing framework and policy.